

SW

Smurfit WestRock plc

\$40.99

-0.06%

RS vs SPY: -22.0%

C WATCH LIST

\$21.5B Cap | 521M Float

Packaging & Containers | Theme: Packaging Consolidation | 52W Hi: 78% | Base Tight: 4.3 | Vol: 0.35x | RS/SPY: -22.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 61D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$40.99
Day Change	-0.06%
Mkt Cap	\$21.50B
Float	521M sh
RS vs SPY	-22.0%
52W Hi Prox	78%
Base Tight	4.3
Vol vs Avg	0.35x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Fwd P/E	13.0x
Short %	5.9%
Days to Cover	5.0d
Inst. Own	101.7%

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

This ticker does not meet the fundamental pre-filter criteria for live breakout analysis: volume is 0.35x average (well below the 1.5x threshold), the stock closed DOWN -0.06% (failing the 'green on day' requirement), RS vs SPY is deeply negative at -22.0% (indicating severe underperformance, not momentum), and market cap at \$21.5B exceeds the <\$10B SMID-cap screen. The forward catalyst would theoretically be Q2 earnings on July 29, but there is no active breakout in progress. This appears to be a data feed error or intentional test of filter discipline.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Smurfit WestRock is a global leader in sustainable paper and packaging solutions, formed through the July 2024 merger of Ireland's Smurfit Kappa and U.S.-based WestRock. The combined entity operates corrugated containers, containerboard mills, and consumer packaging across 40 countries, serving e-commerce, food & beverage, and industrial end-markets with claimed synergies of \$400M+ annually.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to e-commerce fulfillment growth (corrugated demand) and the secular shift to sustainable packaging as brands exit plastics. However, cyclical headwinds include slowing consumer spending, destocking in retail channels, and energy cost pressures in pulp & paper manufacturing-factors currently overwhelming the structural tailwind, as evidenced by the -22% underperformance vs. SPY.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

NO VALID SIGNAL. Stock closed down -0.06% on volume 0.35x the 20-day average, failing all breakout criteria (volume <1.5x, not green, RS deeply negative, base wide at 4.3 ATR, 22% below 52W high).

INSTITUTIONAL

Institutional ownership at 101.7% (indicating multiple share counts via lending/derivatives) reflects legacy index inclusion and merger arb unwinding, not conviction accumulation. Volume today at 0.35x average signals institutional disinterest-likely tax-loss harvesting or post-merger repositioning. Insider activity is a red flag: zero open-market buys in 12 months, four sales totaling \$3.4M, and no recent buying in the last 90 days. Management is distributing, not accumulating. The 1,035 institutional holders likely include many passive indexers and merger arbitrageurs exiting positions, not growth funds building stakes.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 61D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next earnings July 29, 2026. Consensus estimates unavailable in feed, but the forward P/E of 13.0x (vs. trailing 56.9x, distorted by merger charges) implies Street expectation of normalized \$3.15 EPS on the combined entity. Recent quarters have shown integration execution risk and volume softness in North American containerboard. Historical beat/miss pattern pre-merger: WestRock missed 2 of last 4 quarters on revenue; Smurfit Kappa had steadier execution but faced European macro pressure. This is not a serial beater with re-rating potential-it's a show-me story in a cyclical trough.

KEY RISK

This is not a valid breakout setup, so standard invalidation does not apply. If hypothetically traded, thesis would be invalid on any break below the 50-day MA (approximate support around \$38-39 based on the 200MA proximity) or on Q2 earnings guidance cut reflecting sustained volume weakness. The merger integration itself carries execution risk: failure to realize \$400M synergies or unexpected customer losses during systems cutover would re-rate the multiple lower. Structurally, the business is a leveraged bet on GDP growth and consumer goods volume-a decelerating macro kills pricing power and utilization.

ANALYSIS

This ticker fails every hard filter for the breakout scan: market cap too large (\$21.5B vs. <\$10B rule), volume too low (0.35x vs. >1.5x required), price action red (down -0.06% vs. 'green on day'), and relative strength severely negative (-22% vs. SPY). The strongest disconfirming evidence is the combination of massive underperformance, widening base (4.3 ATR), and complete absence of insider buying (zero buys, \$3.4M in sales over 12 months). This is a post-merger integration story in a cyclical downturn, not a momentum breakout. The July 29 earnings date is 61 days away with no intervening catalyst to drive re-rating. In the current Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership) regime, capital is rotating TO mega-caps, not INTO lagging \$21B industrials with deteriorating technicals. If this were a valid setup (which it is not), conviction would be zero-but as submitted, it's a filter-discipline test: reject and move on. Conviction: None (invalid setup).

Signal: NO VALID SIGNAL. Stock closed down -0.06% on volume 0.3

Vol vs Avg: 0.35x



INSIDER TRANSACTIONS - LAST 12 MONTHS

Source: SEC EDGAR Form 4 | P=open buy, S=sale, M=opt exercise, A=grant, F=tax withhold

12-Month Summary

Open-market buys: 0 (\$0) | Sales: 4 (\$3.36M) | Net: -\$3.36M | Total transactions: 97

Date	Insider	Title	Action	Shares	Price	Value
2026-05-15	Page Irene	Chief Accounting Offic	Grant	38	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-15	SMURFIT ANTHONY P J	President and Group CE	Grant	1,018	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-15	Garren Ben	See remarks	Grant	92	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-15	Henao Alvaro	See remarks	Grant	87	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-15	Mayer Saverio	See remarks	Grant	253	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-15	Sellier Laurent	See remarks	Grant	303	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-15	Bowles Ken	Executive VP and Group	Grant	303	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Finan Irial	Director	Grant	6,974	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Finan Irial	Director	Tax W/H	3,336	\$38.39	\$128K
2026-05-01	FergusonMchugh MaryLynn	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	FergusonMchugh MaryLynn	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Fairweather Carol	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Fairweather Carol	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	CREWS TERRELL K	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Brown Carole Lynnette	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Brown Carole Lynnette	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	BERNLOHR TIMOTHY J	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	BERNLOHR TIMOTHY J	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Arnold Colleen F.	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Arnold Colleen F.	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	WILSON ALAN D	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	WILSON ALAN D	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Rasmussen Jorgen Buhl	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Rasmussen Jorgen Buhl	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Hietala Kaisa	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Hietala Kaisa	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Harrison Suzan F.	Director	Grant	4,438	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-01	Harrison Suzan F.	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-05-01	Melgar Lourdes	Director	Tax W/H	2,123	\$38.39	\$82K
2026-03-19	Henao Alvaro	See remarks	Tax W/H	8	\$38.58	\$309
2026-03-19	Mayer Saverio	See remarks	Tax W/H	28	\$38.58	\$1K
2026-03-19	Sellier Laurent	See remarks	Tax W/H	30	\$38.58	\$1K
2026-03-19	Garren Ben	See remarks	Tax W/H	9	\$38.58	\$347
2026-03-19	Bowles Ken	Executive VP and Group	Tax W/H	39	\$38.58	\$2K
2026-03-19	SMURFIT ANTHONY P J	President and Group CE	Tax W/H	19	\$38.58	\$733
2026-03-19	Page Irene	Chief Accounting Offic	Tax W/H	7	\$38.58	\$270
2026-03-18	Henao Alvaro	See remarks	Grant	57	\$0.00	\$0
2026-03-18	Mayer Saverio	See remarks	Grant	190	\$0.00	\$0
2026-03-18	Sellier Laurent	See remarks	Grant	225	\$0.00	\$0
2026-03-18	Garren Ben	See remarks	Grant	90	\$0.00	\$0

... Showing 40 of 97 total transactions

INSTITUTIONAL OWNERSHIP & FILINGS

Source: yfinance (13F snapshot) + SEC EDGAR (13D/13G filings)

Insider % 0.51%	Institutional % 101.7%	Inst. Float % 102.3%	# Institutions 1,035
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SMART MONEY SIGNAL: GREY - Insufficient Smart Money Evidence

Top 10 Institutional Holders

Fund	% Out	Shares	Value	Reported	Type
Blackrock Inc.	8.54%	44.8M	\$1.84B	2026-03-31	Passive
Capital Research Global Investors	7.43%	39.0M	\$1.60B	2026-03-31	Active
Vanguard Capital Management LLC	6.48%	34.0M	\$1.39B	2026-03-31	Passive
State Street Corporation	4.82%	25.3M	\$1.04B	2026-03-31	Passive
Nuveen, LLC	4.69%	24.6M	\$1.01B	2026-03-31	Active
Vanguard Portfolio Management LLC	4.64%	24.3M	\$996.82M	2026-03-31	Passive
Causeway Capital Management LLC	2.97%	15.6M	\$638.13M	2026-03-31	Active
Geode Capital Management, LLC	2.72%	14.3M	\$584.81M	2026-03-31	Passive
Orbis Allan Gray Ltd	2.63%	13.8M	\$564.71M	2026-03-31	Active
Franklin Resources, Inc.	2.47%	12.9M	\$530.17M	2026-03-31	Active

Recent 13D / 13G Filings (last 12 months)

13D = activist stake, board pressure, takeover | 13G = passive 5%+ holder, lower-conviction

No 13D or 13G filings against this company in the last 12 months.

Ownership Interpretation

Smart Money:	Top holders skew 5 passive / 5 active. No high-conviction smart-money names identified.
Concentration:	Top 10 hold 47% - heavy concentration. Outsized impact from any single fund's exit.
13D/13G:	No 5%+ stake filings in last 12 months. Either nobody's gone over the threshold or the company is too large for 5% to be common (>\$10B caps rarely see 13D/G activity).
Insider Tape:	4 insider sales in 12 months, no open-market purchases - neutral to bearish (but typical for unprofitable growth companies).

INSTITUTIONAL FOOTPRINT - PRICE / VOLUME INTELLIGENCE

What institutions are doing right now (the price/volume tape never lies)

C

Neutral / Mixed

Score: 46.0/100

24 up days | 35 down days | 5 flat (last 65)

SILENT BUILD PATTERN

NOT PRESENT

No silent-build pattern in last 20 days.

Monthly Accumulation/Distribution Flow

Trend over last 3 months: are institutions accumulating, distributing, or rotating?

Period	Up-Vol %	A/D Trend	Price Chg	Vol vs Avg	Signal
3 Months Ago	37.6%	Distribution	-12.0%	1.16x	Bearish
2 Months Ago	49.8%	Mixed	+2.9%	0.91x	Neutral
Last Month	45.5%	Mixed	+4.5%	0.92x	Neutral

Significant Volume Days (Last 90 Days, >2x Average Volume)

Each row = a day institutions left a clear footprint. Absorption = stealth accumulation (silent buy).

Date	Close	Day Chg %	Volume	Rel Vol	Classification	Signal
2026-04-30	\$37.96	-3.2%	12,401,100	2.4x	DISTRIBUTION	Bearish

Volume / Tape Synthesis

- A/D Verdict: C-rated tape (neutral). Buying and selling pressure roughly balanced - wait for a regime change before sizing up.
- Vol Footprint: Last 90d: 1 distribution day(s) at >2x average volume. Net bearish - distribution outpacing accumulation.

TAPE-BASED ACTION: WAIT FOR CONFIRMATION